

Add indicators

Instance Setup · ~30 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You've completed **Connect to the platform** and **Import facility structure**
- ☐ Your **FASTR Data Prep Checklist** is open at the *Indicator mapping template* sheet — you'll use column **C — INDICATOR OF INTEREST** (e.g., ANC1, ANC4) and column **G — OFFICIAL INDICATOR NAME IN DHIS2**

WHY IT MATTERS

Without indicators, FASTR doesn't know what to download from DHIS2 or what to call it in the analysis.

What you'll do

For each indicator on your list, three moves on one screen:

1. **Find it** in DHIS2, from inside FASTR
2. **Name it** — a short ID (e.g., `anc1`) and a readable label (e.g., "ANC 1st visit")
3. **Save**

All indicators live in **one table**. Each row has a type: **DHIS2 element** (fetched from DHIS2), **Uploaded** (CSV file), **Sum**, or **Calculated** (a formula). Here you create DHIS2 elements.

1 Open the indicator list

1. Click **Data** in the top bar, then, in the **HMIS** section, the **Indicators** card.
2. Look at the **default list**. Each row shows the **Indicator ID**, its **label**, its **type**, and the **Defined by** column (the DHIS2 code and its original name). If an indicator on your list is already there, skip it.

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HMIS INDICATORS Indicator types Special indicators and reserved words

Indicators (26) Sort Add from DHIS2 Create new

INDICATOR ID	LABEL	TYPE	DEFINED BY	INCLUDE	STATUS
☐ new_fp	New family planning acceptors	Uploaded		☒	
☐ anc1_2	Antenatal care 1	Calculated	penta3	☒	
☐ anc4 Special	Antenatal care 4	DHIS2 element	B19c4S2peU5 B19c4S2peU5	☒	
☐ delivery Special	Institutional delivery	DHIS2 element	mu29nQJ_jnW mu29nQJ_jnW	☒	
☐ sba Special	Delivery by skilled birth attendant	Uploaded		☒	
☐ pnc1_newborn	Postnatal care 1 (newborns)	DHIS2 element	ORIKRAJmDN8 OMIURAJmDN8	☒	
☐ pnc1_mother Special	Postnatal care 1 (mothers)	DHIS2 element	DgJmrgdndfd DgJmrgdndfd	☒	
☐ bcg Special	BCG vaccine	DHIS2 element	WMA1OF1qmYO WMA1OF1qmYO	☒	
☐ zhuR2PwaIFT					

Rows marked "Special" are read by ID by the analysis modules ([anc1](#) , [delivery](#) , [bcg](#) ...). Keep those IDs as they are: fill them with the right DHIS2 code rather than creating new ones.

2 Search DHIS2

1. Click **Add from DHIS2**, top right of the list. FASTR uses the instance's **stored DHIS2 connection** (the **DHIS2 connection** card on the Data page, the same one as the previous step).
2. In the search field, type a term from column **G — OFFICIAL INDICATOR NAME IN DHIS2** (e.g., `antenatal`) or paste the DHIS2 ID. Click **Search**.
3. In the results, click **Add** next to each element you want. It moves to the **Selected items** column.

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< Add indicators from DHIS2 > Next: name indicators (2)

Search indicators and data elements

Search by name, code, or ID

Rapid diagnostic test

Search

Clear

Search completed: 2 results found

	Data element	Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria...	4 COCs	Qk9nx8171Z	+ Added
>	Data element	Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria...	4 COCs	Qk9nx8171Z	+ Added
>	Data element	Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria...	4 COCs	wZwz2Rnr9N4	+ Added

Selected items

2 items selected

Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria negative	Data element	Qk9nx8171Z	Remove
Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria positive	Data element	wZwz2Rnr9N4	Remove

4. Search another term if needed; the selection is kept. Then click **Next: name indicators (N)**.

Tip: a broad word (`vaccine` , `delivery`) brings the whole family at once. Greyed rows saying "Cannot be added" are not monthly counts. **Subgroup** (an age band, a sex)? Unfold the row's **chevron** and add the **COC** line you want, not the main line.

3 Name, then save

FASTR proposes an **ID** and a **label** for each element, built from the DHIS2 name. Replace them:

- **Indicator ID** — the technical name. **Lowercase letters, digits and underscores only**, no accents, no spaces (e.g., `mam_new`). For an indicator on the FASTR list, use its standard ID (`anc1` , `anc4` , `penta1` ...).
- **Label** — the name shown on charts. Accents and spaces are fine; take column **C — INDICATOR OF INTEREST**.

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Name the new indicators Save

Data elements
Each element becomes a new DHIS2 element indicator under the id shown (edit it here; the indicator can be renamed later).

Qk9nnX0171Z Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria negative	
Indicator ID	Label
rdt_malaria_neg	Malaria RDT negative
wZwzzRnr9N4 Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria positive	
Indicator ID	Label
rdt_malaria_pos	Malaria RDT positive

Click **Save**. Repeat steps 2 and 3 until your whole list is covered.

Checkpoint

Back on the list, each new indicator shows the **DHIS2 element** badge, its DHIS2 code under **Defined by**, and a tick under **Include**. The **Indicators (N)** counter went up by as many.

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☐	INDICATOR ID	LABEL	TYPE	DEFINED BY	INCLUDE	STATUS
☐	rdt_malaria_neg	Malaria RDT negative	DHIS2 element	Qk9nnX0171Z Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria negative	✓	edit delete
☐	rdt_malaria_pos	Malaria RDT positive	DHIS2 element	wZwzzRnr9N4 Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria positive	✓	edit delete

What could go wrong

- **"... already exists; choose another id"** — the ID is taken. Open the existing indicator with the pencil and change its DHIS2 code, or pick another ID.
- **"Already added as ..."** — that DHIS2 code is already in FASTR. Nothing to create.
- **The ID is rejected** — an accent, space, comma, bracket, or a reserved word. Lowercase, digits, underscores.
- **DHIS2 search returns nothing** — try another term, or check that the connection's DHIS2 user can read the metadata.
- **"No DHIS2 connection is saved"** — Data page, **DHIS2 connection** card, enter the URL and credentials.
- **Two DHIS2 codes for one indicator** (two age bands to add up) — add both as elements, then **Create new** → type **Sum**.

What's next

The indicators are defined but **no numbers have been downloaded yet**. Move on to **Import HMIS data**.